own heads, and were we to ever come across his body, living or dead, or his image, we would be immediately in a position to cross- check his features against the indelible impress of those features in our nervous systems.

The production of terrorism is not something that happens sui generis. The production of terrorism is almost always, in every society, also a production of images of terror. In fact the fear that terrorism induces in general terms is not so much by way of the actual impact of explosives, gun shots and incendiary or lethal materials but by way of a circulation and amplification of images and their effects. We know this from every instance of spectacular terrorism that we have witnessed in the last hundred years or so. So much so that even more or less arbitrary calendrical notations like 9/11, 12/13 or now, more recently, 7/7, become indexical images of terror. All we need to do is to see a particular alphanumeric arrangement to experience at the very least a twinge of the recognition of the feeling that terror induces. If the production of terrorism is so interlaced with the production of images, we can also say that the production of certain images is also linked to a climate that gives credibility to the production of a certain set of seemingly self-evident truths about terrorism. Sometimes, to create the consequences that a terrorist incident produces, it is necessary to create a strong body of images that will serve the necessary purposes in a focused way.

The tried and tested tactics of infiltration into existing terror cells or political groups, or the creation of such cells where none exist, or when those that exist are too weak to perform a spectacular act of terror, are well documented in the extant literature on the work and function of intelligence agencies of various states. The MI6's murky relationships with the IRA, and later, the provisional IRA, Mossad's successful infiltration of the Palestinian Abu Nidal group, and the Italian and Belgian intelligence agencies' dealings with the mafia, ex-Nazis, far right militias, fascists and secret societies in setting off a chain of spectacular terrorist incidents in the 1980s (including the Bologna train station bombing of 1974 and 1980 that killed 113 people and wounded 180) that could later be attributed to 'left wing' terrorists is very well documented, as is the history of the infiltration of the 'Naxalite' movement in India in the 1970s by the Indian intelligence bureau and special police operatives. The picture of a shadowy dalliance between 'terrorism' and 'counter-terrorism', between 'militants' and 'surrendered militants', between people in and out of different kinds of uniform is also beginning to emerge from the battlegrounds of Kashmir, Assam and the rest of the North East.